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Overview

Purpose	This document defines the requirements for the intake, investigation, product evaluation, documentation, and closure of potential product complaint submissions.
Scope	This document applies to functions that perform product complaint handling activities from intake to closure.
Roles	- Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit - Operating Unit (OU) Complaint Unit - Region Complaint Unit (RCU)

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Terms and Definitions

Term	Definition	Source
Aware Date	The date that an employee of Medtronic, or an entity acting on Medtronic's behalf, acquires information that reasonably suggests that a reportable event has occurred.	Medtronic

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Term	Definition	Source
	Aware Date may or may not be the same date as Notify Date (see definition of Notify Date below). NOTE: See 054-P044 <i>Medical Device Reporting Appendix A</i> for additional detail and examples of Aware Date vs. Notify Date.	
Authorized Device	Authorized means having received regulatory approval for product(s) within the applicable geography for being placed on the market (e.g. released for distribution). Note: For events within Canada: A medical device is considered authorized when having a Medical Device Active License, a Pre- or Post-Market Investigational Testing Authorization (ITA) or approval under the Special Access Program (SAP).	Medtronic
OU Complaint Unit	A unit that executes and maintains processes for receiving, reviewing, and/or evaluating complaints. NOTE: This complaint unit may be comprised of one or more of the following functional groups: Customer Quality Experience Management (CQXM) • Functions/individuals that contribute to complaint analysis/investigation	Medtronic
Complaint	<i>Any written, electronic, or verbal communication that alleges deficiencies related to the identity, quality, durability, reliability, safety, effectiveness, usability or performance of a product, or related to a service that affects the performance of such product*</i> . This definition is applicable to authorized products manufactured, imported, or distributed by Medtronic. * Includes all Medical devices & accessories, cells/tissues/organs (CTO) product, Drug, Biopharma, Combination (device and drug), in-vitro diagnostic medical devices.	Medtronic
Cybersecurity Signal	Any information that indicates the potential for, or confirmation of, a cybersecurity vulnerability or exploit that affects or could affect a medical device.	Medtronic
Event	An occurrence of an allegation against a product or products that are manufactured or distributed by Medtronic.	Medtronic

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Term	Definition	Source
Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	An individual or group that is responsible for establishing, executing, and maintaining processes for receiving, reviewing, and/or evaluating complaints. Comprised of both the OU Complaint Unit and the Region Complaint Unit.	Medtronic
Notify Date	The date when a Medtronic Employee/Agent was initially informed of a potential complaint. Notify Date may or may not be the same as Aware Date (see Aware Date definition above). NOTE: See 054-P044 <i>Medical Device Reporting Appendix A</i> for additional detail and examples of Aware Date vs. Notify Date.	Medtronic
Record	The official record of a complaint or product event, which is a retrievable and searchable file that documents information about the complaint or product event.	Medtronic
Region	A geographic region (e.g., Greater China) or a country within a region (e.g., China).	Medtronic
Region Complaint Unit	A complaint-handling unit that resides within the Region that executes certain process steps.	Medtronic
Regulatory Report	A report that is provided to regulatory agencies regarding adverse events and/or alleged product performance issues (e.g., malfunctions) as required by applicable regulation.	Medtronic
Service	“Service” as it relates to complaints, means activities performed by Medtronic in relation to a device which may have an effect on the identity, quality, durability, reliability, safety, effectiveness, usability or performance of a product (e.g. a device returned from service delivering out of specification).	Medtronic
Sources	A person, area, sector, department, or process that reports information regarding an event.	Medtronic

Process Overview

The Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit is responsible for handling potential product complaints, including timely and uniform intake, evaluation, and investigation.

Medtronic employees who handle complaints maintain and reinforce local patient privacy regulations throughout the complaint-handling process.

NOTES:

- While the process flow is sequential, some steps may start before others finish (for example, submitting a regulatory report before completing analysis and investigation because of regulatory-reporting timelines) or some steps may not be required (for example, no product analysis if no product is returned).
- Monitoring and evaluation of timeliness measures on a periodic and ongoing basis is performed per D00426291, *Perform Management Review*
- Monitoring and trending of complaints is performed per 034, *Product Risk Management*, by Post-Market Product Performance Monitoring/Trending



Process Detail

1. Submitting Potential Complaints

Potential complaints may be received at anytime, anywhere, and from anyone.

Refer to 027-P428 *Submitting Potential Complaints* for the following:

- Understanding Timeliness Expectations for Submitting Potential Product Complaints
- Receiving Potential Product Complaint Information (including Sources of Potential Complaints)
- How to Gather & Submit Potential Product Complaint Information

2. Intake, Assessment, and Complaint Determination

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Upon receipt of incoming information that alleges a potential complaint, ensure that a record exists per 027-WI185, <i>Intake, Assessment, and Complaint Determination</i> . - Ensure that each event has only one associated record. - If multiple sources of incoming information are received regarding a single event and user, merge into one record. - If no record exists, create one. - Include all known information in the record.
2.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Evaluate each record to determine if the event constitutes a complaint per 027-WI185.

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Step	Role	Action
		Upon determination that the incoming information meets the definition of a complaint, process the complaint in a timely manner to meet required timelines outlined in 054-P044, <i>Medical Device Reporting</i> .
3.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Code each record based on the information that is provided, per 027-WI185.
4.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Make requests for additional information regarding the complaint and product in accordance with 027-WI185 and 027-WI188, <i>Customer Communication</i> . Document all requests as part of the event record per 027-WI188.
5.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	When new information is obtained, perform reassessment per 027-WI185 and 054-P044.

3. Reportability Evaluation

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Evaluate each complaint per 054-P044 to determine whether the complaint is reportable to regulatory agencies.
2.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Maintain documentation associated with reportable events in a separate portion of the complaint record or otherwise clearly identified. Clearly identify the complaint as reportable.

4. Product Analysis

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Document activities and results within the complaint record, per 027-WI187, <i>Product Analysis</i>. NOTE: Product analysis may include, but is not limited to, the following items: • Returned devices • Media • Data • Software logs

5. Complaint Investigation

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	- Conduct a complaint investigation in a timely manner for each complaint per 027-WI186, <i>Complaint Investigation</i>. - Review, evaluate, and investigate (if required) any complaint that represents the possible failure of a device, labeling, or packaging to meet any of its specifications (e.g., Quality Control release, design, and manufacturing). - Evaluate and identify potential cybersecurity signals
2.		Maintain a record of the investigation within the complaint file. When available, ensure the complaint file includes the following items: - Name of the device - Date when the complaint was received - Any unique device identifier or universal product code and any other device identification(s) and control number(s) that are used - Name, address, and phone number of the complainant/initial reporter, as permitted by privacy regulations - Nature and details of the complaint - Dates and results of the investigation - Any correction or corrective action that was taken - Any reply to the complainant

6. Regulatory Reporting

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	File the required regulatory report(s) for complaints that are determined to be reportable on or before the due date that is established by the reporting timelines per 054-P044.

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7. Customer Communication

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Document any response provided to the customer in the complaint record per 027-WI188.

8. Complaint Closure

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Close the complaint record when all required steps of the complaint investigation and regulatory reporting are complete. NOTE: Complaints requiring further action or investigation activities can be closed following completion of the complaint investigation per Section 5 above. Document the reference number for the associated corrective action or investigation in the complaint record.
2.		Maintain complaint records to be reasonably accessible to the manufacturer.

9. Quality Monitoring

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	As necessary, participate in the creation, review, and maintenance of Quality Detection Reports per D01175976, <i>Quality Detection Reports for Customer Quality</i> . Quality Detection Reports may be applicable to any sub-process within the complaint handling process.

References

Number	Title
027-WI185	Intake, Assessment, and Complaint Determination
027-WI186	Complaint Investigation
027-WI187	Product Analysis
027-WI188	Customer Communication

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Number	Title
034	Product Risk Management
054-P044	Medical Device Reporting
D00426291	Perform Management Review
D01175976	Quality Detection Reports for Customer Quality

Quality Records

Quality Record	Required Approvals
Complaint Record	None